PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | SIEM/XDR | Detection Engineering | KQL | Threat Hunting

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and detection engineering within large enterprise environments. My expertise centres on Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender XDR, and CrowdStrike Falcon, which I use to build, tune, and operate high-fidelity detection capabilities aligned to real-world threat intelligence and the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I take ownership of the full detection engineering lifecycle from data ingestion and log source onboarding through to rule development, tuning, and response automation using Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR). I have a strong track record of improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates at scale, supporting threat hunting, and leading incident response in complex, multi-site environments with 8,000+ users. I am comfortable working both as an individual contributor and collaborating with infrastructure, identity, and leadership teams to drive security posture improvements.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL), custom detection rule authoring, alert tuning, data connector configuration, log source onboarding
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks, CrowdStrike Falcon SOAR, PowerShell scripting for automated triage and response, runbook development
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven and indicator-based threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, cross-source telemetry correlation
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Incident Response:** Major incident coordination, NIST 800-61 framework, digital forensics, containment and eradication, post-incident review and lessons learned
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Other Tools:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, Tanium, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM), BeyondTrust

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead detection engineering across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, authoring KQL-based detection rules, analytics rules, and hunting queries to identify threats aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Design, configure, and maintain Sentinel data connectors to ingest logs from Microsoft 365, Microsoft Entra ID, Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), firewall, and third-party sources, ensuring comprehensive coverage across the environment.
- Build and maintain Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows to automate alert enrichment, triage, and response actions for common threat scenarios.
- Conduct regular threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hypotheses and KQL queries across Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, proactively identifying adversary behaviours that evade automated detection.

- Operate Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), triaging and investigating Tier 2/3 alerts and escalating or containing confirmed incidents.
- Lead major incident response in accordance with NIST 800-61, coordinating cross-functional teams and providing technical leadership through containment, eradication, and recovery phases.
- Deliver continuous improvement to SIEM detection quality through systematic false positive analysis and rule tuning, reducing alert fatigue and improving analyst productivity.
- Manage identity security controls in Microsoft Entra ID, including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and MFA enforcement, and administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM).
- Own vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), coordinating risk-based remediation with infrastructure and development teams.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Operated Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, performing daily alert investigation and triage using KQL, and maintaining detection rules and analytics policies aligned to organisational risk priorities.
- Administered Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), deploying Defender for Endpoint to 8,000+ devices and maintaining detection policy baselines.
- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon across the endpoint estate, configuring Falcon EDR detection policies and Falcon Prevent prevention rules to reduce the risk of malware and ransomware.
- Authored and maintained PowerShell scripts for SOAR automation, reducing analyst workload for high-volume, low-complexity alert types by automating enrichment and initial triage steps.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises across Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, using MITRE ATT&CK mappings to identify gaps in detection coverage and develop new detection rules.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID security controls including Conditional Access, MFA enforcement, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) for administrative accounts.
- Managed Mimecast email security, investigating phishing campaigns and tuning detection policies to reduce the risk of email-borne threats reaching end users.
- Supported vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracking progress with infrastructure teams.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Supported SIEM monitoring and alert triage, assisting with investigation and escalation of security events to the senior security team.
- Administered endpoint security and device compliance using Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing security baselines across a SaaS/FinTech environment.
- Managed identity and access controls including user provisioning, role-based access reviews, and MFA deployment.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, identifying and tracking remediation of security weaknesses in line with the organisation's risk appetite.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance, supporting risk assessments and audit preparation activities.
- Collaborated with development and quality assurance teams to embed security testing into the software delivery lifecycle, supporting secure configuration reviews.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection library covering 30+ MITRE ATT&CK techniques, including custom KQL analytics rules for insider threat indicators, identity-based attacks, and ransomware precursors.
- Reduced SIEM false positive rate by over 40% through systematic rule tuning and threshold calibration, demonstrably improving analyst focus and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000+ devices, delivering full endpoint telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection and investigation.

- Developed a library of SOAR playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automating response actions for phishing, identity compromise, and malware alert categories.
- Led incident response to multiple high-severity cyber events including ransomware intrusions and business email compromise (BEC), achieving containment before data exfiltration occurred.
- Achieved CISSP certification and maintained continuous professional development across Microsoft, CrowdStrike, and CompTIA platforms, reflecting commitment to remaining current with evolving threats and tools.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)